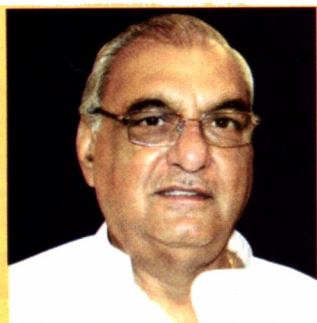


Haryana: modern healthcare and free medicines for all

Poor get free healthcare



"When we came to power five years back, we decided to place the health and family welfare sector on the top of our priorities. These efforts have brought a sea change. The shortage of medicines, doctors and other state staff is now a thing of the past. We have increased the overall spending on health and family welfare sectors. This year alone, a sum of Rs 1,600 crore is being spent, which is an increase of 51 per cent over the 2008-09 expenditure."

Bhupinder Singh Hooda,
Chief Minister

Dr. Jasjeet Kaur/Ruchi Sharma

Haryana has taken huge strides in providing quality healthcare in its institutions. A number of new initiatives have been taken under the dynamic leadership of Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda to provide quality healthcare to its people and make it affordable. The government has guaranteed free healthcare to the poor, including free surgeries and a provision for free medicines to all OPD patients and emergency cases. A unique cost-effective and hassle-free surgery package programme has been put in place. The recruitment of more doctors and the induction of specialists are some of the initiatives which have brought about this qualitative change and put Haryana in the fore-

front as far as health services are concerned.

The state provides healthcare through a network of 47 hospitals, including the PGIMS at Rohtak, 93 community health centres, 435 primary health centres, 20 district TB clinics, 37 PP centres, 16 urban health posts, 18 mobile dispensaries and 2,465 sub-centres.

First state in India to offer free medicines to all

Haryana is the first state to provide free medicines to all outdoor patients coming to dispensaries and hospitals. Besides outdoor patients, casualty and emergency patients are also being provided free medicines. The initiative involves the painstaking effort and reworking of systems at myriad levels. An Essential Drug List (EDL) consisting of 325 drugs has been prepared in consultation with specialists to cater to all possible needs of the OPD patients.

What sets Haryana apart in this unique initiative is the way the state has done micro-detailing to prepare a comprehensive EDL, ensure participation of reputed pharma companies and new systems of decentralised decision making, that seek to empower doctors working in the district hospitals. The results are incredible -- the cost of drugs is unbelievably low with the average patient OPD cost of Rs 10. Further, doctors do not prescribe medicines that have to be purchased from chemists. Haryana thus has effectively eliminated the infamous nexus between pharma companies, chemists and doctors that plagues the other states.

IMPACT

- Number of outdoor patients have increased in all hospitals across the state.
- OPDs in all district hospitals have increased.



Guaranteed free healthcare for poor patients

Haryana is the only state to have decided to treat the poor patients free of cost. All outdoor and indoor treatment has been made free for the BPL families and the residents of urban slums. Even major surgeries, including implants, are now free for this section of the population.

Surgery package programme

In another unique effort, a comprehensive surgery package scheme has been started. Under this, affordable and hassle-free quality surgeries are being conducted at the district-level government hospitals in Haryana. The scheme was launched on July 1, 2009. In the first month itself, 5,247 surgeries were conducted out of which 50 per cent have been done free of cost.

The package includes all pre-test investigations, blood testing charges, besides intra-operative and post-operative medicines. The scheme has done away with the need to run around for medicines besides introducing transparency and accountability.

Surgeries free for all

- Caesarian operations ■ All eye surgeries
- Cleft lip surgeries

Recruitment of doctors

A revolutionary step has been taken in